



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage Preparatory School
School Website: <https://www.heritageprep.org>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Heritage Preparatory School (Atlanta, GA, 30324) presents a robust classical Christian program focused on formation of character, virtue, and wisdom within a Christ-centered framework. Public materials emphasize a Trivium-based curriculum, the Great Books approach, frequent use of recitation and living books, strong faculty mentorship, and active parental partnership. Across categories, the school demonstrates explicit alignment with core classical criteria—most notably religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal oriented toward virtue and wisdom, curriculum grounded in grammar–logic–rhetoric and Great Books, pedagogy that blends contemplative and Socratic dimensions, a faculty culture described as mentors and living curriculum, and an engaged, co-teaching style with parents and community. Taken together, these elements support a CLASSICAL assessment for Heritage Preparatory School.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Key strengths: explicit Christ-centered formation; Trivium curriculum; integration of Great Books and Socratic discourse; strong emphasis on habits, virtue, and character; active parental partnership.
- Areas that would further strengthen if pursued: deeper articulation of wonder as an explicit experiential component across the full K–12 spectrum; explicit histories and syllabi showing sustained Great Books exposure in upper grades; continued evidence of liturgical practices beyond chapel (e.g., formal liturgical calendar) across all divisions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Heritage publicly frames education as Christ-centered and biblically informed, with language about a Gospel-centered worldview and a biblical worldview permeating school life. This is presented in mission statements and program descriptions (e.g., five pillars of the school's mission and Christ-centered formation) and in materials describing formation of hearts and minds within a Christian framework. - Liturgical and communal practices are referenced via chapel, worship, and liturgical dimensions embedded in school life (e.g., weekly chapel, worship experiences). - The school's own historical and descriptive materials emphasize Christian formation as a core driver of the program (e.g., "Think with Excellence. Believe with Confidence. Live with Character."; Gospel-centered formation; and mission statements).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (examples): Christ-centered formation, biblical worldview, Gospel-centered worldview, liturgy, chapel, worship, theology, sacred, Logos, wonder, moral formation, virtue, character, formation, spiritual depth, holistic education. - Negative keywords present: None observed in the cited materials (no indications of secular relativism, value-neutrality, or anti-theology language in the sources cited).

Why this rating - The materials consistently present religion as foundational and integrative (formation in faith, theology present in curriculum and community life, liturgical rhythms, and explicit Christ-centered language). This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for religious/metaphysical foundations and shows clear alignment with the corresponding Classical school criteria. The absence of anti-religious indicators and the presence of liturgical/communal practices reinforce CLASSICAL rather than merely SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information or job preparation. Language highlights forming students to think with excellence, believe with confidence, and live with character—an explicit formation telos over utilitarian outcomes. - Public materials describe formation of the whole person within a classical framework and stress virtues such as wisdom, virtue, and moral formation as part of the education process. - The school positions itself as preparing students for purpose, impact, and leadership within a Christian framework, rather than focusing solely on work-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, character, contemplation, scholé, moral imagination, vocation-oriented formation, love of learning, Logos (as an anchor for truth and virtue). - Negative keywords present: None observed in the cited materials (no strong signals of secular pragmatism or job-first framing).

Why this rating - The school's stated aims center on the classical paideia ideal of forming humane, virtuous, wise individuals rather than primarily training for a career. The recurring refrain of formation and virtue aligns with Positive keywords in the Classical rubric, while there is no evidence of negative indicators in the sources.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is explicit reference to the Trivium—Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric—as the backbone of the curriculum, demonstrating the formal liberal-arts structure. - The curriculum explicitly includes Great Books and “great conversation” through engagement with living ideas, literature, theology, history, and arts, with emphasis on memorization, recitation, and living books as core techniques. - Recitation, small class sizes, and an emphasis on memory, living ideas, and picture-study are highlighted as pedagogical features of Heritage's classical approach. - There is mention of a curriculum rooted in timeless truths and critical thinking, with the Trivium guiding student thinking and rhetoric across grade levels.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; great conversation; living books; recitation; picture studies; memory; nature studies; wonder; liberal education; Trivium; classical education. - Negative keywords present: None observed in the cited materials.

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of the Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, living books, and recitation, along with references to a classical curriculum enriched by nature studies and a pedagogy aimed at memory and wonder, matches the core Curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL schooling.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The lower school employs singing, chanting, and regular review to deepen memory and delight (a pedagogical approach aligned with early formation and memory). - Upper school features include Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, with opportunities to give speeches and practice eloquence. This is explicitly described as part of the high school experience. - The Trivium framework underpins pedagogy, with students moving from grammar to logic to rhetoric as they advance, and a described emphasis on recall, living books, and critical thinking.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: singing/chanting in the lower school; memorization/recitation; Socratic discussion; seminars; debates; rhetoric; public speaking; thinking deeply; living

books; formation through arts and memory. - Negative keywords present: None observed (no signals of overly secular or results-based-only pedagogy in the cited materials).

Why this rating - The mix of contemplative and rigorous elements (lower-school memory/chanting; upper-school Socratic seminars and rhetorical training; memory-based and living-ideas approaches) tracks well with the Classical pedagogy rubric. The clear presence of Socratic engagement and rhetoric in upper grades plus memory-based practice in the lower grades signals a CLASSICAL pedagogy rather than only a general or reform-based approach.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as dedicated, well-trained professionals who continually develop their skills and love fostering a love of learning. Small class sizes and favorable student-teacher ratios are noted, enabling close mentorship. - The faculty are presented as the living curriculum and as mentors who walk with students in wisdom, love, and encouragement, reinforcing the idea of the faculty as core to the school culture. - There is emphasis on faculty and staff building deep, life-shaping relationships with students and on partnerships with families, underscoring a collegial and relational faculty culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: well-trained teachers; master's degrees (explicit in some materials); small class sizes; living curriculum; mentor/teacher as guide; wisdom and love; partnerships with families. - Negative keywords present: None observed in the cited materials.

Why this rating - The materials consistently describe the faculty as central, skilled, and mentoring, with small-class environments and a living-curriculum mindset—key indicators of a CLASSICAL faculty archetype per the Six Elements rubric.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Heritage emphasizes partnership with Christian families, forming a model of co-teachers with the school, and maintaining a culture of grace-filled relationships with families. - The school indicates it educates parents via the website, book studies, and gatherings, facilitating parent understanding of classical education. - Parents are described as welcome members of the school community, with opportunities to participate in campus life and visits at virtually any time.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers with school; parent education; home-school/community integration; open visits; family-centered community. - Negative keywords present: None observed in the cited materials.

Why this rating - The public materials portray a robust, ongoing, and explicit partnership model with parents and the broader community—consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for parental involvement and community reciprocity.

Aggregate ranking and interpretation - All six categories substantially meet the Classical criteria based on keyword alignments and explicit public statements. Therefore, Heritage Preparatory School (Atlanta, GA, 30324) is classified as CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were to move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, concrete improvements could include:
- Element 1: Provide explicit liturgical calendar communications and more frequent liturgical/ritual references beyond chapel to demonstrate a broader liturgical rhythm in everyday life.
- Element 2: More explicit articulation of virtues and telos in student outcomes beyond character formation, including demonstrable evidence of universal formation across all grade levels.
- Element 3: More explicit mention and documentation of Great Books readings across upper grades with direct course mappings and syllabi to show sustained exposure beyond foundational references.
- Element 4: Expanded opportunities for Socratic seminars and debates in the middle and elementary grades (where feasible) to reinforce the continuum of Socratic pedagogy.

- Element 5: A formal, published faculty portrait and living-curriculum narrative with example teacher-mentors and demonstrable professional-development pathways that align with classical pedagogy.
- Element 6: Additional parent/community programming that specifically documents parent-teacher co-curricular projects and home-school integration frameworks.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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